EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Conversational AI is being marketed across life sciences workflows, creating new ways to access information, analytics and decision support

OUTSIDE-IN RESEARCH LENS

An assessment of publicly marketed conversational AI across five Optum Life Sciences decision workflows:

RWE | **Commercial intelligence** | **Medical / regulatory research** | **Clinical trials** and **Market access**

The U.S. competitive landscape is the primary focus; selected international offerings provide context; and Optum LS is the strategic reference point.

KEY FINDINGS

19 The U.S. screen identified 19 qualifying conversational AI offerings across five decision workflows, concentrated in RWE and commercial intelligence.

10 The selected international comparison identified 10 qualifying offerings, providing additional examples of how vendors position conversational interaction.

OPTUM POSITIONING

Optum LS publicly emphasizes linked healthcare data, AI-enabled research tools and scientific expertise.

Several competitors prominently market conversational interfaces as the entry point to comparable customer tasks.

This reflects differences in public positioning, not necessarily in underlying functionality.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION

The competitive significance of conversational AI depends on the customer task, underlying data and reliability of the results.

Where could conversational interaction add value to Optum's existing offerings?

Evidence boundary: Public product marketing and announcements reviewed as of October 13, 2026. The findings describe selected screened inventories—not a market census, adoption rates, verified product performance or undisclosed capabilities.

RESEARCH CATALYST

Recent RWE product launches prompted a broader examination of conversational AI across life sciences

A series of public announcements brought greater attention to natural-language access to healthcare data, cohort exploration and research workflows.

SELECTED PUBLIC PRODUCT ANNOUNCEMENTS

2024

Earlier precedents

February: Tempus One / Lens — AI-assisted research and cohort exploration

September: Komodo MapAI — conversational healthcare analytics

August 2025

Platform expansion

Komodo Marmot — AI-powered healthcare analytics and research workflows

April–May 2026

Research-interface launches

Truveta Intelligence — natural-language RWE research questions

Flatiron Telescope — conversational oncology cohort exploration

September 2026

New releases

Verana Agent Claire — conversational specialty-data research

Norstella Atlas Patient Analytics — agentic, managed cohort analytics

BROADER COMPETITIVE SIGNAL

AI model providers are actively expanding enterprise sales into life sciences, offering models, integrations and implementation partnerships that may accelerate AI adoption among established healthcare-data vendors.

THE BROADER COMPETITIVE QUESTION

Where else are life sciences vendors marketing conversational AI, what tasks does it serve, and how does that positioning compare with Optum Life Sciences?

OUR RESEARCH RESPONSE

Expand beyond RWE to assess publicly marketed conversational AI across five Optum-aligned decision workflows, prioritizing the U.S. competitive landscape and using selected international offerings for context.

Evidence boundary: Dates reflect selected public announcements or releases, not necessarily first feature availability. The timeline illustrates a research catalyst, not measured market-wide growth. AI-enabled or agentic launches are not automatically qualifying conversational products; the Norstella example is excluded from the final conversational count.

U.S. COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Conversational AI is most prominent in RWE among screened U.S. competitors; Optum has relevant offerings across five decision workflows

U.S. COMPETITIVE SCREEN

45 competitor groups initially screened → **15** distinct groups marketing qualifying conversational AI → **19** qualifying conversational AI offerings across five decision workflows

COMPETITOR COVERAGE AND OPTUM LS POSITIONING

U.S. competitors marketing chat / all comparable competitors	Workflow	Representative conversational AI offerings	Optum's publicly marketed offerings	Optum public chat claim
9 / 34	**RWE**	Komodo Marmot and MapAI; Truveta Intelligence; Flatiron Telescope; Tempus Lens	Analytics on Demand; epidemiology research	○
3 / 23	**Commercial intelligence**	IQVIA Field Force Agent and GMI Agent; ZS Conversational AI for Commercial; Trinity InsightsEDGE Digital Twins	Market Clarity: portfolio and patient/prescriber analytics	○
3 / 18	**Medical / regulatory research**	IQVIA Med-R1; ZS Conversational AI for Medical; Veeva Vault AI Chat	Postapproval safety studies; Market Clarity medical affairs insights	○
1 / 25	**Clinical trials**	TriNetX Terrain AI Assistant	Prospector; Digital Research Network; True Source	○
1 / 24	**Market access**	EVERSANA Ask NAVLIN	HEOR/value evidence; Evidence Engine	○

Scope note: Offerings are organized by their primary customer decision workflow; supporting data and analytics capabilities may serve more than one workflow.

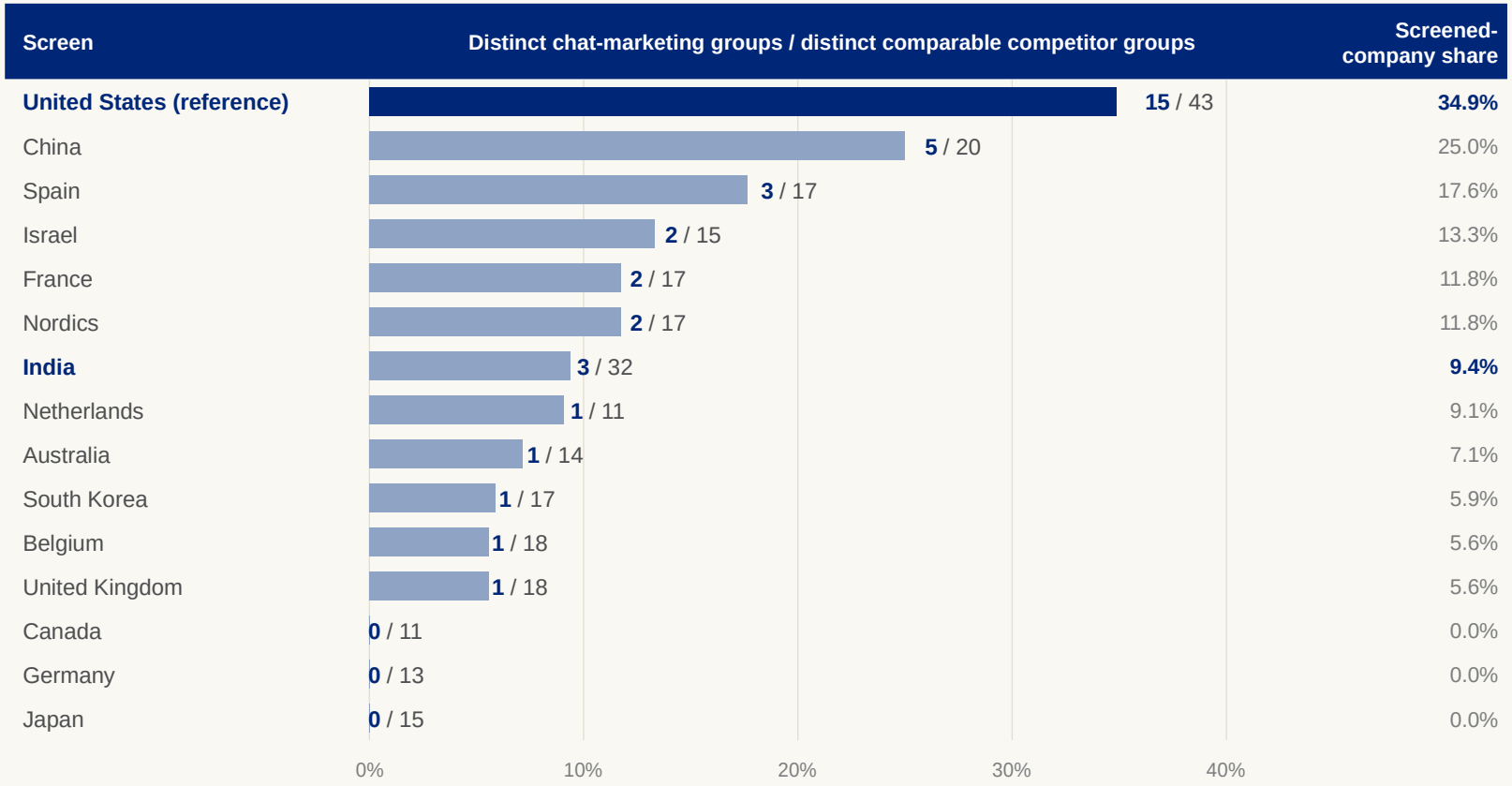
○ *Not publicly established in this review*

KEY TAKEAWAY

RWE has the largest number of screened U.S. companies marketing qualifying conversational AI. Optum offers products and services across the five decision workflows shown, but a qualifying customer-facing conversational interface was not established in the reviewed public materials.

Selected international screens identify additional competitors marketing conversational AI across Optum-relevant workflows

COMPARABLE COMPETITOR GROUPS MARKETING QUALIFYING CHAT — FIVE DECISION WORKFLOWS



HOW TO READ THE COMPARISON

Each bar represents distinct company groups publicly marketing at least one qualifying conversational offering divided by distinct direct or specialized/partial competitor groups comparable in at least one of the five decision workflows. Count each group once per screen. International numerators and denominators exclude companies already represented in the qualifying U.S. chat inventory.

NEXT: FROM COMPANY SCREENS TO THE ACTUAL PRODUCTS

The following slides examine the specific marketed conversational tools and corresponding Optum Life Sciences offerings, beginning with RWE dataset assessment, cohort exploration and research analysis.

Competitors are marketing conversational tools to assess healthcare datasets, explore cohorts and answer RWE questions

RWE DATA ACCESS AND ANALYSIS — COMPETITIVE EXAMPLES

CUSTOMER TASK	COMPETITOR CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM OFFERINGS
Identify and assess suitable data	Merative's **MarketScan Snapshot**: natural-language assessment of dataset suitability; HealthVerity's **eXOs**: conversational exploration of connected healthcare data	Market Clarity Data; linked claims/EHR data; Enriched Clinical Data
Explore patient populations and cohorts	Komodo Health's **Marmot** and **MapAI**: conversational healthcare analytics and cohort exploration; Truveta's **Truveta Intelligence**: natural-language research questions over longitudinal clinical data; Briya's **AIRE Population Agent (Israel)**: natural-language cohort eligibility and feasibility assessment	Analytics on Demand; Clinical Notes Lab; Prospector
Investigate broader RWE questions	Norstella's **Ella AI**: conversational RWE analytics; BC Platforms' **BC Catalyst (Finland)**: prompt-based cohort building and clinical/genomic research exploration	Analytics on Demand; epidemiology research services

QUESTIONS FOR COMPARISON

What information can researchers query directly? What outputs can they generate, inspect and reuse? Where do dataset permissions, cohort definitions or specialist involvement constrain the experience?

EVIDENCE BOUNDARY *Scope: Six qualifying U.S. conversational offerings plus two selected international examples. Optum offerings are task-level comparators, not established conversational equivalents. Descriptions reflect public marketing, not independently verified performance or data access.*

Specialty-data platforms bring conversational AI into oncology research and more narrowly defined evidence questions

SPECIALIZED RWE — COMPETITIVE EXAMPLES

CUSTOMER TASK	COMPETITOR CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM OFFERINGS
Explore oncology and specialty cohorts	Flatiron Health's **Telescope**: conversational oncology cohort exploration; Tempus's **Lens**: clinical and molecular research exploration	Enriched Clinical Data; clinicogenomics datasets
Investigate specialty-disease evidence	ConcertAI's **Precision Explorer**: oncology research analytics; Verana Health's **Agent Claire**: conversational specialty-data research; OrigiMed's **OMSmartData (China)**: AI-supported analysis of oncology real-world data	Clinical Notes Lab; epidemiology and observational research
Analyze curated research datasets	MDClone's **ADAMS Copilot (Israel)**: conversational statistical analysis and visualization within controlled research datasets	Analytics on Demand; research data and study environments

WHERE DOES CONVERSATIONAL ANALYSIS END AND SCIENTIFIC EVIDENCE GENERATION BEGIN?

Optum also markets epidemiology studies and Evidence Engine services. The conversational products above are not automatically equivalent to those scientific services.

QUESTIONS FOR COMPARISON

Which tools support exploratory questions versus reproducible study analyses? What supporting methods, provenance and review can customers inspect? Which capabilities are publicly demonstrated, and which require further validation?

EVIDENCE BOUNDARY *Scope: Four qualifying U.S. conversational offerings plus two selected international examples. Product descriptions are based on public marketing; study-grade reliability, data entitlements and actual deployment are not independently established.*

Commercial AI products extend conversational interaction into market intelligence, field decisions and simulated stakeholder research

COMMERCIAL INTELLIGENCE — COMPETITIVE EXAMPLES

CUSTOMER TASK	CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM OFFERINGS
Pharmaceutical market and portfolio intelligence	IQVIA's **GMI Agent**: global market insights; GBI Health's **GBI BOT** (China): pharmaceutical database Q&A and competitive intelligence; Prospection's **ProGPT** (Australia): conversational patient and market insights for brand planning	Market Clarity: market attractiveness and portfolio research
Commercial field and prescribing decisions	IQVIA's **Field Force Agent**: commercial field support; ZS's **ZAIDYN Conversational AI for Commercial**: commercial information and decision support; Close-Up International's **Xplora AI** (Spain): AI-enabled pharmaceutical CRM and commercial intelligence	Market Clarity: patient and prescriber analytics
Simulated stakeholder research	Trinity Life Sciences' **InsightsEDGE Digital Twins**: conversational simulated personas; Ipsos's **Healthcare PersonaBot** (France): interaction with simulated healthcare stakeholders	Market Clarity provides market insights; a directly comparable simulated-persona offering was not established in the Optum review

BEYOND THE PUBLIC EVIDENCE

Which decisions are these products designed to support? What underlying commercial information can users access? Where does an assistant move beyond analytics into field execution or simulated research?

TRANSITION TO OTHER WORKFLOWS

How does the comparison change for medical affairs, clinical development and market access, where the intended users, evidence requirements and decisions differ?

EVIDENCE BOUNDARY *Scope: All four qualifying U.S. commercial conversational offerings plus four selected international examples. Customer tasks are not interchangeable; Optum comparisons are based on public offerings, not feature-for-feature validation. International examples are illustrative, not a geographic prevalence comparison.*

Competitors market conversational tools for scientific evidence, medical insights and regulated content workflows

U.S. SCREEN: 3 COMPANIES | 3 QUALIFYING OFFERINGS

CUSTOMER TASK	COMPETITOR CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM OFFERINGS
Search and synthesize scientific evidence	IQVIA's **Med-R1 Deep Research Agent**: synthesizes biomedical, clinical and regulatory sources to answer complex research questions	Epidemiology research; postapproval safety and comparative-effectiveness studies
Explore medical insights and support scientific engagement	ZS's **ZAIDYN Conversational AI for Medical**: natural-language analysis of care gaps, scientific insights and opinion-leader information; Evidenze's **AI medical-education chatbots (Spain)**: conversational medical education and knowledge support	Market Clarity medical affairs evidence and MSL insights
Question and navigate regulated documents	Veeva's **Vault AI Chat**: questions, summaries and follow-up interactions within authorized Vault documents and records	Optum's safety and evidence-research services are adjacent; a directly comparable document-chat offering was not established in the review

QUESTIONS FOR COMPARISON

Which offerings help users find evidence, and which help them interpret or act on it? What source traceability, permissions and scientific review are built into the marketed experience? Where are these fundamentally different services?

Evidence boundary: Three qualifying U.S. offerings plus one selected Spanish example. The examples span distinct tasks; scientific research, medical education, document assistance and pharmacovigilance are not interchangeable. Optum comparisons reflect publicly marketed capabilities, not verified conversational equivalence.

Conversational offerings address specific trial operations and pricing questions—not the entire clinical or market-access workflow

TWO DISTINCT WORKFLOWS — COMPETITIVE EXAMPLES

CUSTOMER TASK	COMPETITOR CONVERSATIONAL AI OFFERINGS	RELEVANT OPTUM OFFERINGS
Trial feasibility, site and investigator identification	TriNetX's **Terrain AI Assistant**: natural-language questions about trial sites, investigator experience and patient populations	Prospector Data Mining Studio; Optum Digital Research Network
Clinical-trial document operations	Taimei's **Wiz-iCTA (China)**: conversational assistant supporting trial project teams and document-management work	Optum True Source supports clinical-trial source-data capture; a directly equivalent document assistant was not established
Pharmaceutical pricing and market-access intelligence	EVERSANA's **Ask NAVLIN**: conversational access to pricing, reimbursement and market-access information	Optum HEOR and value evidence; Evidence Engine; health economic and budget impact modeling

QUESTIONS FOR COMPARISON

For trials, does the interface help identify viable sites, evaluate patients or manage trial documents—and how far does it go?

For market access, is the customer asking for pricing intelligence, reimbursement information or new economic evidence? Where do the vendor offerings overlap with Optum, and where do they solve a different problem?

Evidence boundary: Clinical trials — one qualifying U.S. offering and one selected Chinese example. Market access — one qualifying U.S. offering. No additional qualifying international market-access offering was identified in the selected inventory. The Optum comparisons are based on customer-task overlap, not identical product functionality.

AI technology providers are expanding into pharmaceutical workflows through partnerships, specialized offerings and acquisitions

A SECOND COMPETITIVE DYNAMIC

The preceding slides examine conversational AI products marketed by established life-sciences data, technology and services companies. At the same time, AI model and infrastructure providers are pursuing life-sciences customers through several distinct approaches—some complementary to incumbent platforms, others potentially competitive.

THREE OBSERVED APPROACHES TO ENTERING LIFE SCIENCES

AI SUPPLIER APPROACH	SELECTED PUBLIC DEVELOPMENTS	COMPETITIVE SIGNIFICANCE FOR OPTUM LIFE SCIENCES
Partner with established life-sciences vendors	**Anthropic + Komodo Health:** A documented partnership supporting AI-enabled healthcare analytics; **Anthropic + Veeva:** Claude incorporated into Veeva's industry-specific AI offerings; **AWS + Datavant:** Explore Assistant, publicly described in February 2026, uses Bedrock and AWS Clean Rooms to support natural-language assessment of healthcare datasets and research feasibility.	AI suppliers can contribute underlying technology to existing life-sciences platforms while those companies retain specialized data, applications and customer relationships. Komodo and Veeva already appear in our competitive analysis.
Develop their own life-sciences-specific products and tools	**Anthropic's Claude for Life Sciences:** Specialized scientific tools and integrations supporting research, clinical trials and regulatory workflows; **OpenAI's GPT-Rosalind:** A purpose-built model for biology, drug discovery and translational research, with access expanded to eligible organizations in September 2026.	Rather than acting only as technology suppliers, AI companies are building offerings aimed more directly at life-sciences users. These products are not necessarily direct substitutes for Optum's RWE and healthcare-data offerings, but they illustrate potential expansion into adjacent customer workflows.
Acquire specialized life-sciences capabilities	**Cohere + Reliant AI:** In May 2026, Cohere acquired a biopharma AI company offering literature review, competitive landscaping and scientific/regulatory information extraction. The acquisition supports development of North for Pharma, a planned specialized agentic offering.	Acquisitions provide another way for AI companies to obtain industry-specific technology, expertise and pharmaceutical customer relationships—potentially strengthening their ability to supply or compete with established life-sciences platforms.

THE STRATEGIC QUESTION FOR OPTUM LIFE SCIENCES

As AI providers expand beyond supplying general-purpose models, where will they remain technology partners to established life-sciences vendors—and where might they increasingly compete for the same pharmaceutical customers and workflows?

What could these developments mean for the competitive positions of companies whose offerings combine differentiated healthcare data, research tools and scientific expertise?

SLIDE 3 — METHODOLOGY NOTE

Comparable competitors include **direct and specialized/partial offering-level competitors** serving similar customer tasks; adjacent participants are excluded. Counts represent distinct company groups per workflow, not product totals. A company may appear in multiple workflows. Optum's ○ indicates that a qualifying conversational interface was *not publicly established in this review*, not that the capability is absent. These are selected screened companies, not market-wide adoption rates.

SLIDE 4 — INDIA RECONCILIATION

Of 37 screened companies, 36 qualify as direct/specialized comparators in at least one of the five decision workflows; excluding four companies already represented in the qualifying U.S. chat cohort leaves 32. Three additional chat-marketing companies qualify: Axtria, Doceree and Genpact. Company presence in an India screen does not prove the specific product is available or deployed in India.

SLIDE 4 — EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

Selected country/region screens differ in research depth and company composition and are not representative national market samples. The Nordics screen groups Denmark, Finland, Norway and Sweden. A multinational may appear in multiple country screens; the counts are not additive across countries. A globally marketed product does not establish locally verified use. Percentages show shares within screened comparable companies, not regional adoption, customer penetration or product deployment rates.

SLIDE 10 — EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

These are selected publicly documented developments, not an exhaustive assessment of AI suppliers. The three approaches are neither mutually exclusive nor predictions of future competition. They do not establish that AI suppliers caused the recent RWE launch cluster, are displacing established vendors, or expose an Optum capability gap. Not all supplier offerings qualify as conversational products; they are not additions to the deck's product counts. North for Pharma was described as planned; Explore Assistant's general commercial availability was not established in our review.